ST. CHARLES PREPARATORY SCHOOL

PSAT Math — Test Day

Honors Geometry · Mr. Nappier · taken online in Bluebook

WHAT YOU ARE WALKING INTO

Shape	44 questions in two modules of 22. Thirty-five minutes each, with a break between.
Pace	About 95 seconds per question — half again as long as the ACT gives you. Slow down and read.
Adaptive	How you do on Module 1 decides how hard Module 2 is. Module 1 is the one that sets your ceiling.
Calculator	Desmos is built into Bluebook and allowed on every question. So is your own.
Formulas	A reference sheet is in the app. Stop memorizing areas and volumes — open the sheet.
Answers	Most are multiple choice; about a quarter you type in yourself.

MODULE 1 IS NOT A WARM-UP

- Finish it. An unanswered question in Module 1 does not just cost that question — it routes you to an easier Module 2, and an easier Module 2 has a lower score at the top of it.
- You can move freely inside a module, but once Module 1 closes it is closed. Spend the flags before the module ends, not after.

LET DESMOS DO THE WORK

- Graph it instead of solving it. Type both sides of an equation as two functions and read the intersection. That is a legal, intended use — not a shortcut.
- Systems of equations: graph both lines, click the point. Quadratics: graph and read the zeros.
- Type the question in as it is written. Desmos accepts fractions and exponents the way you would write them on paper.
- Know when NOT to open it. If you can see the answer, seeing it is faster.

BECAUSE IT IS ON A SCREEN

- Use Mark for Review, then the review page at the end of each module to come back. It is faster than clicking Back twenty times.
- Use the answer eliminator. Crossing out two choices on screen does the same work as crossing them out on paper, and it survives you scrolling away.
- Scratch paper still matters. Set up your work in quadrants, one question per quadrant.
- Type-in answers: check the form before you submit. No commas, no units, no dollar signs — just the number.

Tonight: sleep. Tomorrow: your laptop charged, your own calculator if you want it, and a water bottle. The clock is kinder on this test than on the ACT — use the extra seconds to read the question twice.